

Authentication

This manual covers the Kraken API in full. The API authenticates every request with either an API key or an OAuth bearer token. API keys are issued from the developer dashboard and must be sent in the X-Kraken-Key header on every request. Keys expire after 90 days unless rotated.

Production integrations use OAuth 2.0 with the authorization-code grant. Access tokens expire after 3600 seconds; refresh tokens last 30 days. Both are issued by POST /v2/oauth/token.

All endpoints require an authenticated caller. Unauthenticated requests are rejected with HTTP 401 and the KRK-001 error code.

Rate Limits

Kraken API accounts are bucketed by tier. Each tier bounds the number of requests per minute, requests per day, and the burst capacity. When a caller exceeds its bound the server responds with HTTP 429 and an X-Rate-Limit-Retry-After header carrying the number of seconds to wait before retrying.

Per-tier limits are listed in the table below. The Free tier is intended for evaluation only; production traffic should run on Tier 2 or Tier 3.

Tier	Reqs/min	Reqs/day	Burst
Free	60	10000	120
Tier 2	500	200000	1000
Tier 3	1500	2000000	3000

Error Codes

Every Kraken API endpoint returns standard HTTP status codes. Authentication failures surface as 401, missing permissions as 403, missing resources as 404, and rate-limit exhaustion as 429. Internal errors surface as 500.

On any 4xx response, the JSON body includes a Kraken-specific `error_code` field. Common codes include KRK-001 (invalid API key format), KRK-002 (key expired), KRK-003 (OAuth token expired), KRK-101 (missing required field), and KRK-201 (rate limit exceeded for this account tier).